Fourth, e-commerce sales exceed 80 per cent in South Korea, 60 per cent in Japan and 45 per cent in the US. India's share of e-commerce sale is much smaller. Cross-border B2C sales from India are almost non-existent whereas they exceed 5 per cent for quite a few countries.

Fifth, the top 100 websites located in South Asia, including India, are hardly requested outside the region. In contrast, the top 100 websites located in the US–Canada are requested almost everywhere in the world.

Sixth, not a single top seventy global platform providing different e-commerce services—transportation, delivery, financial services, entertainment, media, search—is Indian.

We do have a dominant presence in the business process outsourcing (BPO) services industry with more than 50 per cent share of the global market. However, this is more on account of our productive digital labour than digital entrepreneurship, capital or technology prowess.

Programmatic Initiatives for Promoting Digital Economy

The Government of India has undertaken several programmes to promote digitalization of governance and digital empowerment of the common man. However, there is no coherent and well-directed strategy for digitalization of the economy. This is hurting India's growth potential.

The government undertook a number of small standalone programmes in the 1980s–1990s to advance the objective of electronic governance. In the middle of the first decade of the new millennium, it adopted the National E-governance Programme, bringing together thirty-odd discrete programmes. Further consolidation and additions have led to the programme being rechristened as 'Digital India'.

Digital India also focuses on digital governance and citizens' empowerment and organizes the government's programmatic interventions in nine pillars. Though there is an element of digital infrastructure creation, it is not a Make in India programme to manufacture hardware and software